substrates, universals and their particular instances, and individuators (***vishesha***) and the permanent substances (for example, souls and atoms) that they uniquely specify by inhering therein.

A complex substance is a whole (***avayavin***) inhering in each of its parts. A cloth cannot continue in existence without the threads, while the threads may exist separately. Qualities and action inhere in substances. The particular case of the quality blue that is a feature of some lotus needs the lotus for its occurrence. A quality is always a property *of* something. Although *we* never encounter a lotus without some quality or other, at the first moment of its existence, the substance has neither qualities nor actions. Quality presupposes substance but substance does not presuppose quality. Qualities (and actions) only exist in some substance that supports them.

Universals inhere in substances, qualities and motions. An individual cow is nothing unless it is an instance of the generic property cowness.

It may appear that if x and y are joined by R and R is also a reality, we will need further connections to relate R to x and R to y. This would generate an infinite series of relations. To avoid this, the tradition holds that inherence relates itself to its terms – it behaves like glue.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Halbfass 1992; Potter 1977

Samkhya: one of the six orthodox Hindu systems of salvation (***Darshana***), usually associated with the ***Yoga*** tradition. The school's basic text is the *Samkhya Karikas* of *Ishvarakrishna* (c. 400–500 CE) upon which there are commentaries among which are the *Yuktidipika* (c. 650 CE) and ***Vachaspati Mishra***'s *Tattvakaumudi* (c. 841 or 976 CE). *Samkhya*, a world-renunciatory outlook, posits a dualism of souls (*Purusha* – an infinity of isolated, inactive